



▲ KERR DOUBLE-ACTION REVOLVER

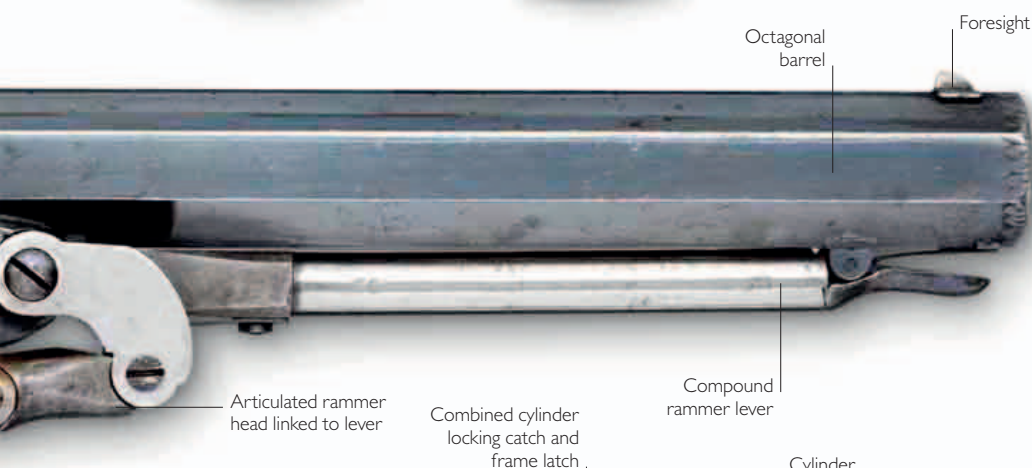
Date 1856

Origin UK

Barrel 5¼in (14.7cm)

Caliber .44in (11.17mm)

James Kerr, Robert Adams's cousin, equipped his solid-frame revolver with a separate lock and a side-mounted hammer. The lock was held by two screws and could be easily removed. If a component broke, any gunsmith would have been able to repair it.



◀ JOSEPH LANG TRANSITIONAL REVOLVER

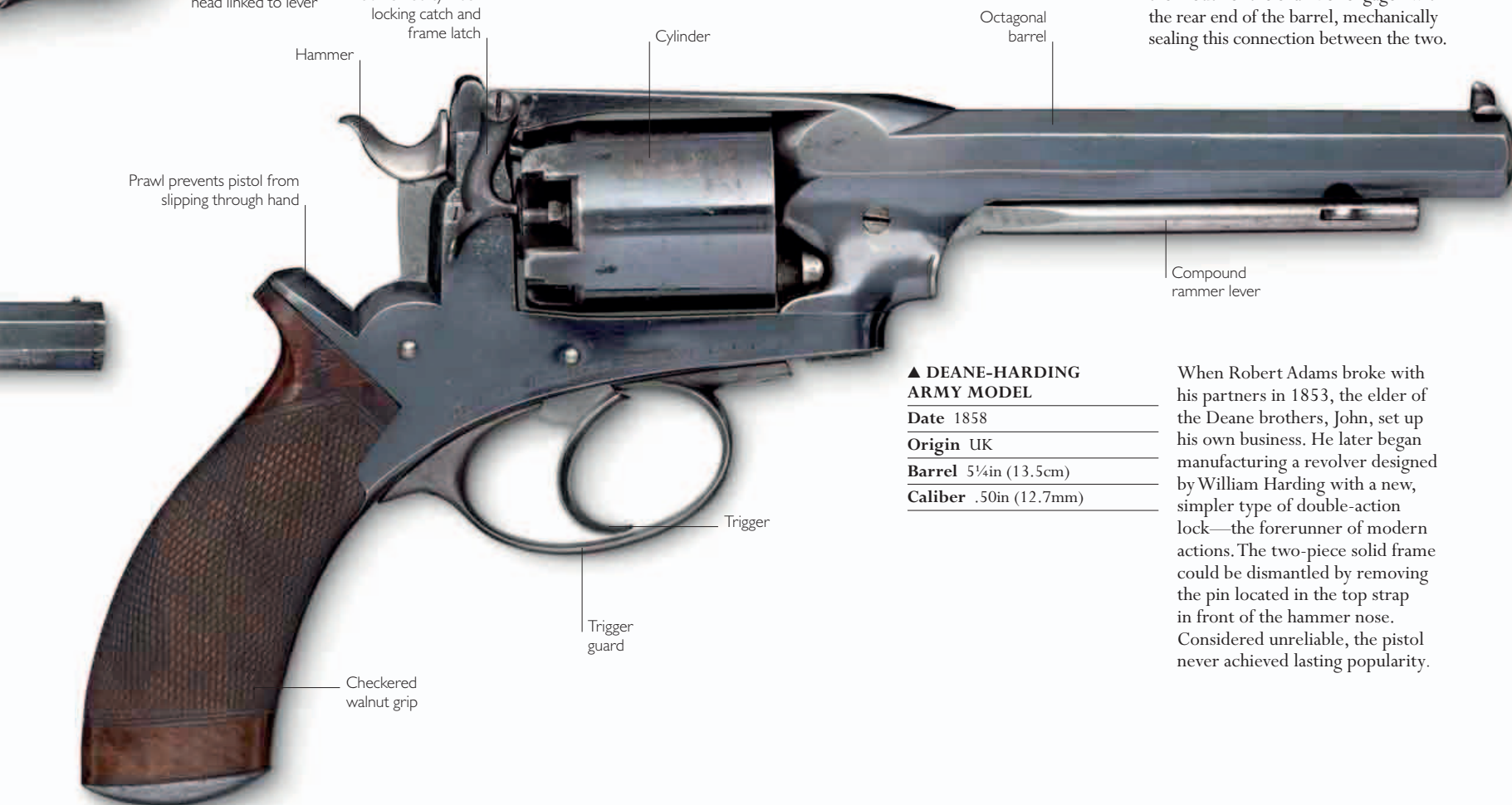
Date 1855

Origin UK

Barrel 6in (15.2cm)

Caliber .44in (11.17mm)

Transitional pistols continued to be produced, mostly in Europe, even after much more sophisticated designs had appeared. This open-frame, single-action revolver is of the type produced by one of the best-known proponents, Joseph Lang of London. Lang was more successful than most gunmakers of the time in solving the problem of propellant gas leaking between chamber and barrel. He designed the revolver in such a way that when the cylinder rotated and each chamber reached the end of the barrel, the mouth of the chamber engaged with the rear end of the barrel, mechanically sealing this connection between the two.



▲ DEANE-HARDING ARMY MODEL

Date 1858

Origin UK

Barrel 5¼in (13.5cm)

Caliber .50in (12.7mm)

When Robert Adams broke with his partners in 1853, the elder of the Deane brothers, John, set up his own business. He later began manufacturing a revolver designed by William Harding with a new, simpler type of double-action lock—the forerunner of modern actions. The two-piece solid frame could be dismantled by removing the pin located in the top strap in front of the hammer nose. Considered unreliable, the pistol never achieved lasting popularity.